AWESOME CYBER SECURITY HEAVEN · REALM DOSSIER · 2026 EDITION

The Armory

Offensive Security, Pentesting & Bug Bounty Tools

58	405,503	97%	52
FREE TOOLS	COMBINED STARS	ON GITHUB	ACTIVE IN 2026

58 tools · ← Back to the main list · Data verified **2026-10-22** (re-verified monthly)

CURATOR'S NOTES

The professional offensive toolkit for authorized engagements, red-team exercises and training labs — the weapons every pentester reaches for first.

MAINTENANCE SNAPSHOT (2026-10-22)

- **Active in the last 30 days:** 41 of 56 tracked GitHub repos (73%)
- **Part of Awesome Cyber Security Heaven** — 509 curated free tools across 14 realms

FLAGSHIP PICKS — THE HEAVYWEIGHTS

TOOL	★ STARS	CREATED	LAST PUSH	WHAT IT DOES
Metasploit Framework	39.2k	2011	2026-10-21 ✅	Metasploit Framework
sqlmap	38.8k	2012	2026-10-21 ✅	Automatic SQL injection and database takeover tool
Nuclei	32.2k	2020	2026-10-21 ✅	Nuclei is a fast, customizable vulnerability scanner powered by the global security community and built on a simple YAML...
masscan	26.1k	2013	2026-10-05 ✅	TCP port scanner, spews SYN packets asynchronously, scanning entire Internet in under 5 minutes.
MobSF	22k	2015	2026-10-21 ✅	Mobile Security Framework (MobSF) is an automated, all-in-one mobile application (Android/iOS/Windows) pen-testing, malw...
RustScan	20.6k	2020	2026-10-20 ✅	🤖 The Modern Port Scanner 🤖

Full Inventory — 58 curated tools

ranked by GitHub adoption · 2026-10-22 census · non-GitHub entries listed last

TOOL	★ STARS	CREATED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE / TIER
Metasploit Framework	39.2k	2011	2026-10-21 ✅	— the world's most-used pentest framework; thousands of validated modules for exploitation, post-engagement evidence gathering and reporting in authorized tests. Used by professional penetration testers and red teams in authorized engagements; the open-source counterpart to commercial exploitation platforms like Core Impact and Cobalt Strike.
sqlmap	38.8k	2012	2026-10-21 ✅	— the definitive SQL injection detection and exploitation tool for authorized web application testing. Used by penetration testers everywhere for SQL injection proof; the definitive free SQLi automation tool with no real commercial equal. (GPL-2.0)
Nuclei	32.2k	2020	2026-10-21 ✅	— template-driven vulnerability scanner; the huge community template corpus gives it detection breadth no single scanner matches. Used by bug bounty hunters and enterprise security teams alike for template-driven scanning at scale; a free staple that rivals paid web-scanning engines for public attack-surface checks.
masscan	26.1k	2013	2026-10-05 ✅	— the fastest TCP port scanner on earth; scan the whole internet in minutes — on networks you're authorized to test. Used by researchers and recon teams for internet-scale port discovery. (AGPL-3.0)
MobSF	22k	2015	2026-10-21 ✅	— all-in-one mobile app security: static + dynamic analysis for Android/iOS in a single pipeline. Used by mobile app security testers for static and dynamic analysis; the open-source alternative to commercial mobile app testing suites. (GPL-3.0)
RustScan	20.6k	2020	2026-10-20 ✅	— modern Rust port scanner that finds open ports in seconds and pipes them straight into Nmap. Used by bug bounty hunters and sysadmins for fast port discovery with Nmap piping; a modern free alternative to legacy scanners. (GPL-3.0)
Bettercap	20.2k	2018	2026-08-13	— the Swiss-army knife for authorized network assessments: ARP/DNS spoofing, MITM proxies, WiFi and BLE modules. Used by network penetration testers for authorized MITM analysis; the modern successor to Ettercap in most toolkits. (GPL-3.0)
Impacket	16.2k	2015	2026-10-21 ✅	— the standard Python library for low-level Windows protocol work (SMB, LDAP, Kerberos); powers wmiexec/secretsdump-class tooling and AD assessments. Used by red teamers and AD security researchers; the Python underpinning of countless offensive and defensive toolkits.
OWASP ZAP	16k	2015	2026-10-15 ✅	— the open-source intercepting proxy and scanner — a full free Burp alternative with CI/CD integration and a big add-on ecosystem. Used by web pentesters, QA teams and bug bounty beginners.
THC-Hydra	12.4k	2014	2026-07-30	— the classic parallelized login cracker for 50+ protocols; password audits only on systems you own or are paid to test. Used by pentesters for authorized login audits across 50+ protocols; the classic parallelized cracker with no commercial equal. (AGPL-3.0)
Red-Teaming-Toolkit	10.8k	2018	2026-05-07	— curated index of adversary-emulation and red-team tradecraft resources. Used by red teamers planning their tooling stack. (curated list)
Nikto	10.8k	2012	2026-10-20 ✅	— venerable web-server scanner; noisy but thorough on server misconfigurations and default files. Used by web server auditors for two decades; the venerable free complement to commercial web scanners' misconfiguration checks. (GPL-3.0; DB files have custom terms)
WPScan	9.8k	2012	2026-10-21 ✅	— black-box WordPress scanner: plugin/theme enumeration and version-based vuln lookups. Used by WordPress security auditors and managed-service providers; the standard black-box WordPress scanner, free alternative to paid WP security suites. (free for non-commercial use)
objection	9.5k	2017	2026-09-17	— Frida-powered runtime exploration toolkit for mobile apps — inspect and manipulate iOS/Android at runtime. Used by mobile pentesters for runtime exploration without jailbreaks; the go-to Frida front-end for mobile engagements. (GPL-3.0)
Tsunami	8.6k	2020	2026-10-06 ✅	— Google's security scanner for large fleets, focused on reliably exploitable high-severity flaws with few false positives. Used by security teams scanning large fleets of internet-facing services; Google's open-source answer to commercial enterprise web scanners.

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aircrack-ng	7.8k	2018	2026-10-09 ✅	— the complete WiFi security audit suite: capture, inject and audit — the wireless standard for two decades. Used by WiFi security auditors worldwide; the complete free suite replacing any commercial WiFi assessment tool. (GPL-2.0)
MITRE Caldera	7.5k	2017	2026-10-12 ✅	— scalable adversary-emulation platform built on ATT&CK; run purple-team exercises that prove your detections actually fire. Used by red teams and purple teams for automated adversary emulation; the open-source alternative to commercial breach-attack-simulation platforms like AttackIQ and SafeBreach.
RsaCtfTool	7.2k	2015	2026-10-11 ✅	— RSA security-testing tool: attacks weak keys and unprotected disclosures purely offline, for auditors and CTF practice. Used by CTF players and crypto researchers attacking weak RSA keys; a niche free tool with no commercial counterpart. (GPL-3.0)
WhatWeb	6.9k	2010	2026-04-02	— identifies what a website is built with — frameworks, CMSs, servers and versions — in one command. Used by recon teams to fingerprint what a site runs on; the standard free tech-identifier behind many commercial recon feeds. (GPL-2.0)
Responder	6.6k	2016	2026-06-10	— LLMNR/NBT-NS/MDNS poisoner; the fastest way to demonstrate credential-leak exposure on an authorized internal network. Used by internal penetration testers to demonstrate credential exposure on enterprise networks; the canonical LLMNR/NBT-NS poisoner. (GPL-3.0)
osmedeus	6.6k	2018	2026-10-04 ✅	— workflow engine that chains recon and scanning into scheduled, repeatable attack-surface pipelines. Used by recon teams automating full attack-surface workflows; the free alternative to commercial ASM platforms for scheduled recon.
wafw00f	6.6k	2014	2026-04-19	— fingerprints the web application firewall sitting in front of a site so you know exactly what you're testing against. Used by pentesters planning engagements to fingerprint WAFs first; the standard free WAF detector.
NetExec	5.9k	2023	2026-10-21 ✅	— CrackMapExec's actively maintained successor; audit credential hygiene and service misconfigurations across whole subnets. Used by internal network auditors and AD pentesters for credential-hygiene sweeps.
commix	5.9k	2015	2026-10-22 ✅	— automated OS command injection detection and exploitation for web tests. Used by web pentesters for command-injection proof; a focused free tool that complements general-purpose commercial scanners. (GPL-3.0)
Dalfox	5.3k	2020	2026-10-19 ✅	— fast XSS scanner with DOM-aware analysis and a strong payload set; the modern XSS go-to. Used by bug bounty hunters for fast, DOM-aware XSS scanning; a favorite free alternative to Burp's scanner for XSS-only sweeps.
OpenVAS Scanner	4.9k	2018	2026-10-21 ✅	— Greenbone's open-source vulnerability scanning engine for network and service flaws. Used by security teams running unauthenticated network vulnerability scans; the classic open-source alternative to Nessus, Qualys and Rapid7 InsightVM. (GPL-2.0)
afrog	4.4k	2022	2026-10-22 ✅	— fast cross-platform vulnerability scanner driven by a 1,700+ community-maintained YAML PoC corpus covering CVE, CNVD, unauthorized-access, default-password and fingerprinting checks. Used by bug bounty hunters and pentesters running corpus-driven scans; the open-source scanner with one of the largest community PoC collections. (MIT)
tplmap	4.2k	2016	2024-04-21 ⏳	— server-side template injection detection and exploitation across a dozen template engines; quiet upstream but still the SSTI reference. Used by pentesters for server-side template injection proof across a dozen engines; no commercial equivalent needed. (GPL-3.0)
GitTools	4.2k	2015	2026-09-29 ✅	— recovers an exposed `.git` directory into full source and commit history — audit your servers before attackers do. Used by bug bounty hunters to recover exposed .git directories into full source; the go-to free tool for this bug class.
Ghauri	4.1k	2022	2025-10-04 ⏳	— a strong sqlmap alternative for error/union/blind SQLi with clever parameter tampering; slower release cadence but unique value. Used by bug bounty hunters for tricky blind, error-based and time-based SQLi.
BloodHound	3.5k	2023	2026-10-22 ✅	— maps the shortest attack paths through Active Directory; defenders run it to find and fix their way to Domain Admin. Used by Active Directory pentesters to map hidden attack paths; the standard tool defenders also run to harden AD.

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kiterunner	3.3k	2021	2026-07-10	— API route brute-forcer with method-aware wordlists derived from Swagger specs; dormant upstream, still the reference. Used by API security testers brute-forcing routes with method-aware wordlists; the open-source alternative to commercial API discovery scans. (AGPL-3.0)
ettercap	2.8k	2012	2026-09-20	— the veteran MITM analysis suite for ARP poisoning, sniffing and protocol dissection — bettercap's classic sibling. Used by network pentesters and students learning MITM analysis; the veteran suite that inspired later tools like Bettercap. (GPL-2.0)
wapiti	1.9k	2020	2026-10-05 ✅	— open-source black-box web vulnerability scanner that crawls and audits without needing a browser. Used by web pentesters and CI pipelines for black-box web scanning; a solid free alternative to paid web vulnerability scanners. (GPL-2.0)
InQL	1.8k	2018	2026-10-19 ✅	— the reference GraphQL security testing toolkit as a Burp Suite extension: schema introspection analysis, query generation, vulnerability scanning and engine fingerprinting. Used by pentesters auditing GraphQL APIs where classic proxies stop at the surface; doyensec-maintained since 2018. (Apache-2.0)
graudit	1.7k	2009	2026-10-13 ✅	— grep-based rough source-code auditor: one shell script + 26 regex signature databases (php, sql, xss, secrets, java, python…) for first-pass static review. Used by auditors triaging unfamiliar codebases before deep review; 17 years maintained, v4.1 (2026). (GPL-3.0)
Akto	1.5k	2023	2026-10-22 ✅	— self-hosted API-security platform that builds a continuous API inventory from mirrored runtime traffic and runs business-logic tests (BOLA, BFLA, OWASP API Top 10) in CI. Used by API security teams testing business-logic flaws generic DAST misses; the open-source alternative to API-scanning SaaS. (MIT)
Artemis	1.2k	2022	2026-10-21 ✅	— modular web-vulnerability scanning platform that powers CERT Poland's nation-scale scanning (50.6k domains since 2023) and auto-generates human-readable, FP-filtered advisory reports per organization. Used by CSIRTs running continuous constituency scanning with e-mailable advisories; the public blueprint for national-scale detection. (BSD-3-Clause)
JoomScan	1.2k	2016	2024-09-11 ⏳	— OWASP's Joomla scanner: vulnerable components and misconfigurations on Joomla sites; quiet upstream, still OWASP's reference. Used by pentesters auditing Joomla deployments; OWASP's free Joomla scanner. (GPL-3.0)
Pywerview	1.1k	2016	2026-04-21	— a Python port of PowerView's AD recon verbs; same questions, no Windows host required. Used by AD pentesters who live on Linux but need PowerView-style Windows enumeration; the Python port of the classic PowerView. (GPL-3.0)
goshs	993	2020	2026-10-20 ✅	— hardened HTTP file-transfer server built for engagements: upload/download, authentication, access control and TLS — the modern replacement for `python -m http.server`. Used by pentesters on engagements as a hardened file-transfer server; the security-hardened alternative to spinning up ad-hoc Python servers.
h5i	804	2026	2026-10-22 ✅	— agent-native web-security workspace: deterministic recon, secrets scanning, DOM post-message auditing and CI regression checks — fully usable without any LLM key. Used by security engineers wanting agent-native, deterministic web checks; a newer open alternative to dashboard-driven commercial scanners. (Apache-2.0)
Realm	638	2022	2026-10-21 ✅	— open-source adversary-emulation framework with cross-platform implants and Terraform-driven C2 infrastructure for authorized red teams. Used by red teams running repeatable, scoped adversary emulation; the open-source alternative to commercial adversary-simulation platforms. (GPL-3.0)
OXO	582	2021	2026-10-21 ✅	— pip-installable security-scanning orchestrator that composes Docker-image agents (nmap, nuclei, ZAP, subfinder…) into typed asset scan graphs with a CLI + GraphQL API. Used by security engineers chaining multi-tool pipelines without glue code; scans IPs, domains, links, files and mobile apps. (Apache-2.0)
authz0	428	2022	2026-10-14 ✅	— CLI broken-access-control tester that replays the same URL set under multiple roles' credentials from a YAML template and flags unauthorized responses. Used by pentesters proving BOLA/authz gaps in minutes instead of hours; role-pair replay made repeatable. (MIT)
ACSTIS	326	2017	2021-10-20 ⏳	— the classic AngularJS client-side template injection scanner — legacy framework, still found everywhere. Used by bug hunters verifying this niche on legacy apps. (unmaintained classic)

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jiraffe	206	2020	2026-04-02	— Jira recon and security auditing: version fingerprinting, gadget/permission checks and CVE mapping for authorized instances. Used by bug bounty hunters targeting Atlassian deployments; a focused free exploitation kit for the Jira bug class. (MIT)
PWN	86	2022	2026-10-21 ✅	— Ruby offensive-security automation framework that orchestrates Burp, Nessus, OpenVAS, ZAP and other engines into scripted authorized engagements. Used by pentesters chaining commercial and open engines from one Ruby CLI; the glue layer for multi-engine engagements. (MIT)
Nullock	41	2026	2026-09-30 ✅	— zero-telemetry HTTP/2 and WebSocket-native Burp alternative with a plugin ecosystem. Used by privacy-conscious web testers; the telemetry-free Burp alternative. (MIT)
rcekit	25	2025	2026-10-21 ✅	— zero-dependency RCE confirmation toolkit with false-positive-resistant sink tiering. Used by pentesters confirming command-injection findings safely; the confirmation tier for injection testing. (MIT)
Sniper	14	2026	2026-10-22 ✅	— fast Rust-native intercepting proxy with passive scanning and AI agent support. Used by web testers wanting a lightweight daily proxy; the Rust alternative for intercepting work. (MIT)
pentool	8	2026	2026-10-05 ✅	— console-based Burp alternative with crawler, scanner and CI/CD mode. Used by terminal-first pentesters; the TUI web-testing workbench. (AGPL-3.0, copyleft)
WAVSS	8	2025	2026-10-22 ✅	— audit-first web vulnerability scanner for common flaws like SQLi and XSS, with domain-ownership verification, DoS-avoidant pacing and PDF reports with remediation guidance. Used by auditors scanning client sites safely under strict rules of engagement; the audit-focused alternative to exploit-heavy scanners. (no license yet — verify before reuse)
2m[2MNY Website Vulnerability Scanner	3	2026	2026-10-22 ✅	— open-source web vulnerability scanner with 200 deterministic modules: OWASP Top 10, XSS/SQLi/SSRF, subdomain takeover, WordPress and AI/LLM surface checks, CVSS-scored evidence and HTML/PDF reports. Self-hosted via Docker. Used by security teams that want evidence-backed, deterministic scanning they can self-host; the open-source alternative to paid scanner SaaS for website attack surfaces. (maintainer's project)
wp-hunter	2	2026	2026-10-20 ✅	— bilingual WordPress plugin triage toolkit with static authorization analysis, archive integrity checks and version monitoring. Used by WordPress security researchers auditing plugins; the plugin-audit toolkit for WP research. (MIT)
perseid	-	2026	2026-10-21 ✅	— memory-bounded Rust Burp alternative with no artificial rate limits. Used by long-running web test sessions; the resource-frugal intercepting proxy. (Apache-2.0)
Burp Suite Community Edition	—	—	—	— the industry-standard intercepting proxy for manual web testing; the free tier is where nearly every bug hunter starts. Used by web penetration testers as their daily intercepting proxy; the free tier of the industry-standard Burp Suite Professional. (free, proprietary)
Nmap	—	—	—	— the original network mapper: port, service and OS discovery plus the NSE scripting engine for everything from TLS audits to SMB checks. Used by virtually every network security auditor on earth; the open standard that commercial scanners built their discovery phases on.